

# Formula 1 Car: The Test Bed For Road Car Tech!

*While winning the Grand Prix is one aim, the idea is also to introduce, tweak, implement and improve newer technologies. Here we go behind an F1 car and what makes it tick...*

## DRAG REDUCTION SYSTEM

Moveable aerodynamics isn't a new concept. An aircraft's wing flaps open and close while landing or cruising. The same technology has been introduced into the F1 car, called Drag Reduction System (DRS). The adjustable rear wing is supposed to assist with overtaking. Under the rules implemented for the 2011 season, the driver of a following car can open the flap on the car's rear wing, but only at certain times. If a following car is at less than one second's gap behind the car ahead of it, the DRS system will be activated, indicated by a green light on the steering wheel. The idea is to offer less resistance to the wind, particularly when closely following a car, and allow more grip levels to offer an overtaking opportunity.

## THE COCKPIT

- This is where the driver sits
- Avg. cockpit temp exceeds 50 degree C.

## THE GEARBOX

- 7 forward and 1 reverse gear
- Gear changes in 1/100th of a second
- Semi-automatic sequential gearboxes

## THE FUEL TANK

- 12 litres of fuel filled in 1 second

## THE ENGINE

- 2.4 litre V8 engines
- 900bhp of grunt

## THE STEERING WHEEL

- Nerve center of controls of an F1 car
- Weighs about 1.7 kg
- Controls more than 100 settings, configurable while driving
- Costs in excess of ₹15 lakh to make one of these

